

## Understanding Attachment Disorders and Attachment Styles

Healthy relationships begin with how we bond. The way a child connects with a caregiver shapes how they view themselves, others, and the world. When this bonding process is disrupted, it may lead to attachment disorders in childhood. Later in life, early experiences often shape our attachment styles as adults.

At KaziMind Wellness, we believe that understanding both is the first step toward healing and cultivating healthier connections.

### Attachment Disorders (in Children)

Attachment disorders occur when a child does not form a secure emotional bond with their caregiver, often due to neglect, trauma, or inconsistent care. These conditions can affect trust, emotional regulation, and social development.

#### The two main types are:

##### 1. Reactive Attachment Disorder (RAD)

- Children withdraw emotionally, avoid comfort, and struggle to show positive emotions.
- Example: A child resists hugs or comfort even when upset.

##### 2. Disinhibited Social Engagement Disorder (DSED)

- Children show little fear of strangers, seek attention in unsafe ways, and have poor social boundaries.
- Example: A child eagerly approaches or follows unfamiliar adults without caution.

Important: Attachment disorders are diagnosed only in childhood, not adulthood.

### Attachment Styles (in Adults)

While adults do not have attachment disorders, the way they relate to others often reflects their early bonding experiences. These patterns are called attachment styles, and they influence how we connect in friendships, family, and romantic relationships.

#### The four main attachment styles are:

##### 1. Secure Attachment

- Comfortable with closeness and independence.
- Example: Communicates openly and trusts partners.

##### 2. Anxious (Preoccupied) Attachment

- Craves reassurance and fears abandonment.
- Example: Constantly worries if their partner still cares.

##### 3. Avoidant (Dismissive) Attachment

- Values independence and avoids emotional intimacy.
- Example: Keeps distance or avoids deep conversations.

#### 4. **Disorganized (Fearful-Avoidant) Attachment**

- Wants closeness but fears getting hurt.
- Example: Pulls partners close, then pushes them away.

At KaziMind Wellness, we help individuals, families, and organizations explore these patterns and work toward cultivating secure, supportive bonds.

 0202020830/ 0700479944

 [admin@kazimind.com](mailto:admin@kazimind.com)

 Within Sportsman's Arms, Nanyuki

 [www.kazimind.com](http://www.kazimind.com)

